

4 January 2011

THE ARAB SPRING BEGINS

Discontent with poor living conditions and repressive regimes spread across North Africa into the Middle East. It reached new heights when the self-immolation of a street trader triggered protests in Tunisia. In the ensuing power struggles, existing regimes were brought down in Libya, Egypt, and Yemen, as well as in Tunisia itself, while large-scale demonstrations rocked Algeria, Morocco, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon, Jordan, and Oman, among other countries.



△ Tunisian protesters

2010

31 October 2011 The UN officially declares the population of the planet to have exceeded 7 billion people

March 2010 Eyjafjallajökull, an Icelandic volcano, erupts, disrupting air travel across northern Europe



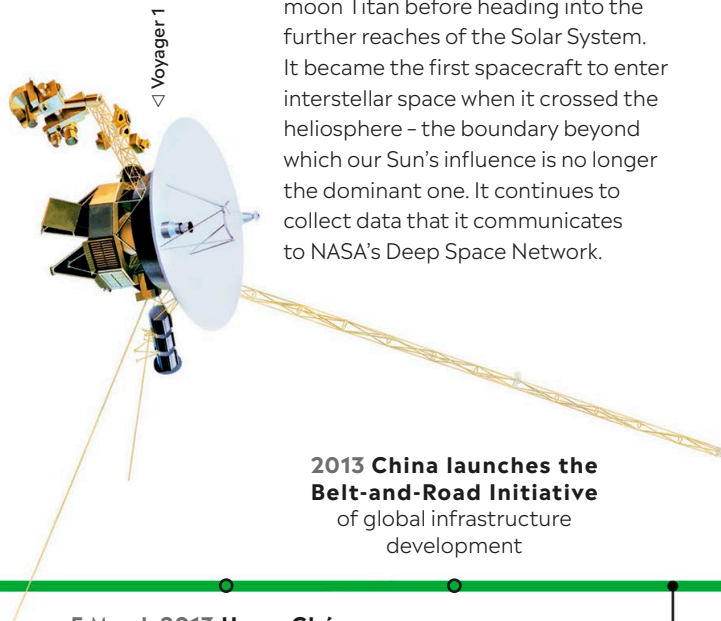
**1954-2013
HUGO CHAVEZ**

After becoming Venezuela's President in 1998, Chávez went on to win three further elections. Buoyed by record oil revenues, he pursued a programme of social reforms designed to help the poor.

25 August 2012

VOYAGER 1 ENTERS INTERSTELLAR SPACE

Launched in 1977, the Voyager space probe made successful flybys of Jupiter, Saturn, and Saturn's largest moon Titan before heading into the further reaches of the Solar System. It became the first spacecraft to enter interstellar space when it crossed the heliosphere – the boundary beyond which our Sun's influence is no longer the dominant one. It continues to collect data that it communicates to NASA's Deep Space Network.



2013 China launches the Belt-and-Road Initiative of global infrastructure development

5 March 2013 Hugo Chávez, president of Venezuela since 2002, dies at the start of a fourth term in office

3 July 2013

EGYPT'S PRESIDENT MORSI IS FORCED FROM POWER

Mohamed Morsi came to power in the wake of the Arab Spring demonstrations that forced the resignation of his predecessor, Hosni Mubarak. A former leader of the Islamist Freedom and Justice Party, Morsi stirred protests in their turn from anti-Islamist demonstrators. In response, the military staged a coup that removed Morsi from power, replacing him with General Abdel Fattah al-Sisi.



△ Protesters gather in Tahrir Square, Cairo